Face recognition is 1:N Match (one-to-many). UIDAI does 1:1 match (match against the stored biometric of the Aadhaar number holder).

What is Face Authentication?

1. UIDAI uses face authentication as a process by which an Aadhaar number holder's identity can be verified. A successful face authentication confirms that your physical face which is being scanned for verification matches the one which was captured at the time of enrolment when your Aadhaar number was generated. A successful face authentication confirms that you are who you claim to be. 2. Face authentication is based on a 1:1 matching which means that the facial image captured during authentication is matched with your facial image which is stored in the Repository against your Aadhaar Number, which was captured at the time of enrolment. 3. Face authentication is consent based.

When do I need to authenticate?

Various government schemes and private service providers such as PDS, NREGA, banks and telecom operators have adopted Aadhaar authentication for verification of their beneficiaries/customers. The authentication is generally done either at the time of delivery of benefits or subscribing to the service.

What are the benefits of Aadhaar authentication?

Aadhaar authentication provides an instant mechanism to prove your identity through online authentication. Therefore one need not carry any other ID proof except Aadhaar number.

Is there a mechanism to notify the Aadhaar number holders when an authentication occurs against their Aadhaar number?

UIDAI notifies the authentication on the registered email of the Aadhaar number holder. Every time UIDAI receives a biometric or OTP based authentication request against an Aadhaar number, a notification is sent to the registered email address.

I received an authentication notification even though I did not authenticate myself. Whom do I approach?

Hardware Security Module (HSM)

Frequently Asked Questions

How to download the Aadhaar app?

How to register on the Aadhaar app?

Which services are available on this app?

View more F.A.Qs →

UIDAI contact information, call centre number and e-mail Id are provided in the UIDAI's notification email. You may contact UIDAI with the authentication details provided in the notification e-mail.

Do I need to authenticate with only my thumbs?

Aadhaar authentication can be achieved with any of the ten fingers. In addition Aadhaar authentication can be done by IRIS and Face too.

What if my authentication request gets rejected even though I provide my fingerprints with my Aadhaar number?

If fingerprint authentication fails, Aadhaar number holders can Retry with correct placement and pressure of finger on fingerprint scanner Retry with different fingers Cleaning the fingerprint scanner Cleaning the fingers If biometric authentication fails repeatedly over a period of time, Aadhaar number holder may approach an Aadhaar update center and get their biometrics updated with UIDAI.

Will I be denied my entitlements (ration, NREGA job etc.) if my authentication request is rejected?

UIDAI and the service providers availing Aadhaar authentication recognize the fact that Aadhaar authentication is subject to certain technological and biometric limitations such as poor fingerprint quality, network availability etc. Therefore the service providers will have alternate processes to identify/ authenticate their beneficiaries/ customers, including exception handling mechanism at their point of presence, so that Aadhaar number holders are not denied entitlements due to technological or biometric limitations.

How will I authenticate if my fingerprints are worn out / I have no fingers?

Authentication user agencies are advised to deploy alternate authentication mechanisms such as Face authentication, Iris authentication, OTP authentication to handle such issues. Additionally, service provider may have other methods of verification of their beneficiaries.

How do I request for OTP?

OTP can be requested through Authentication user agency (AUA)' application requiring OTP authentication on mobile number registered with UIDAI.

Which devices can be used for face authentication?

A Smartphone/Tablet can be used for face authentication which meets the specifications as laid down in UIDAI Face RD API (subject to change time to time)

Can face authentication be used in self-assisted mode?

Yes, depending on the purpose as mentioned by the AUA/SUBAUA, face Authentication can be used in self-assisted mode.

Who can use Face Authentication?

Face authentication has been introduced by UIDAI as an additional mode of authentication. Anyone who has a valid Aadhaar can authenticate using this mode of authentication.

How UIDAI's Face Authentication is beneficial for us?

Face authentication is a touch less mode of authentication, which is a best alternative towards providing a solution to worn out/ damaged finger minutiae.

How do I enable face authentication for my Aadhaar?

This is always on enabled mode by default since individual gives the biometric including face at the time of capture.

What are the benefits of using face authentication?

Face authentication is a contactless method of authentication, which makes it more convenient than fingerprint or iris scanning.

Can any mobile be used for face authentication or does UIDAI prescribes any specification w.r.t the use of mobile ?

Face authentication can be performed with any android mobile having the following specifications

How to download Face authentication application?

To use face authentication one must download two applications, one of the entity and other of Aadhaar Face RD UIDAI. To download Aadhaar Face RD, go to Google Play Store and look for the "Aadhaar Face RD (Early Access) Application" from UIDAI (presently v0.7.43) Link to download https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=in.gov.uidai.facerd

What are the steps for successful face capture?

i. Position yourself: Stand facing the camera or device, ensuring your entire face is clearly visible within the designated frame. Maintain a neutral expression with your eyes open and mouth closed and Stay still during the capture process to avoid blurry images. ii. Focus and capture: The device or app will automatically attempt to focus on your face. Stay still and avoid sudden movements until the image is captured and follow specific instructions for capture, like blinking once or moving your head slightly. Look directly at the camera and maintain a neutral expression for successful capture. iii. Lighting conditions: Stand in a well-lit environment with minimal shadows on your face and for successful capture good background with proper lighting conditions must be ensured. iv. Remove any hats, glasses, or other coverings that might obscure your facial features.

What are the Steps for successful face authentication if failure occurrence is recitative?

UIDAI errors are displayed with an error code assigned for the causes leading to failure, one may contact to concerned entity with the error code to resolve.

Aadhaar Lock/Unlock

What is Aadhaar (UID) Lock & Unlock?

For an Aadhaar number holder, security and privacy of personal data is always a primary concern. To strengthen the security of his/her Aadhaar number and to provide control to the Aadhaar number holder, UIDAI provide a mechanism of locking and unlocking Aadhaar number (UID).
Aadhaar number holder can lock his or her Aadhaar (UID) via UIDAI website (www.myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in).
By doing this Aadhaar number holder cannot perform any sort of Authentication using UID, UID Token & VID for Biometrics, Demographic & OTP modality
If Aadhaar number holder wants to unlock UID he/she can do so by using latest VID, through UIDAI website.
After unlocking Aadhaar (UID), Aadhaar number holder can perform authentication using UID, UID Token & VID.

How can Aadhaar number holder Lock UID?

For Locking UID, Aadhaar number holder should have 16 digit VID number and it's a pre-requisite for locking. If Aadhaar number holder don't have VID can generate via SMS Service or UIDAI website (www.myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in). SMS Service. GVID space last 4 or 8 digit of UID. SMS to 1947. Ex- GVID 1234. Aadhaar number holder may visit UIDAI website (https://resident.uidai.gov.in/aadhaar-lockunlock), Under My Aadhaar tab, Click on Aadhaar Lock & Unlock services. Select UID Lock Radio Button and enter UID Number, Full Name, and Pin Code as in latest details and enter Security code. Click on Send OTP or select TOTP and click on submit. Your UID will be locked successfully.

How can Aadhaar number holder Unlock UID?

For Unlocking UID Aadhaar number holder should have latest 16 digit VID and if Aadhaar number holder forgot 16-digit VID, he can retrieve latest VID through SMS services
RVID Space last 4 or 8 digit of UID. SMS to 1947. Ex- RVID 1234

To unlock UID, Aadhaar number holder may visit https://myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in/, select Unlock radio button, Enter Latest VID and security Code and click on send OTP and click on Submit. Your UID will be unlocked successfully.
Aadhaar number holder may also use Aadhaar lock or unlock service through Aadhaar app.

Why should I lock my Aadhaar?

Locking Aadhaar adds an extra layer of security. Once locked, Aadhaar-based authentication using UID, VID or UID Token cannot be performed until it is unlocked by the Aadhaar number holder.

When should I consider locking my Aadhaar?

Aadhaar number holders who do not frequently use Aadhaar-based authentication or who wish to enhance the security of their Aadhaar may choose to lock their Aadhaar.

Can I lock my Aadhaar permanently?

Aadhaar remains locked until the Aadhaar Holder chooses to unlock it using the latest VID. There is no automatic expiry of the lock.

Will locking Aadhaar affect my Aadhaar number or demographic details?

No. Locking Aadhaar does not affect the Aadhaar number or any demographic information such as name, address, date of birth, or mobile number.

Can I still download my e-Aadhaar when my Aadhaar is locked?

Yes. If the Aadhaar number holder had already logged into the Aadhaar App prior to locking Aadhaar, he/she can still download e-Aadhaar through the app. Locking Aadhaar only restricts Aadhaar-based authentication. Aadhaar number

holders can continue to access Aadhaar services that do not require Aadhaar authentication.

Can I use Aadhaar App if my Aadhaar is locked?

No, if Aadhaar is locked, Aadhaar service cannot be accessed as Aadhaar app can be logged-in through Aadhaar Authentication.

What happens if someone tries to authenticate using my Aadhaar when it is locked?

Authentication requests using the locked Aadhaar (UID), UID Token, or VID will not be successful until the Aadhaar is unlocked.

Do I need a registered mobile number to lock or unlock my Aadhaar?

Yes. A mobile number registered with Aadhaar is required to receive OTPs and access the Aadhaar Lock/Unlock service.

What should I do if I forget my VID while my Aadhaar is locked?

You can retrieve the latest VID using UIDAI's online services, Aadhaar application, or SMS service from your registered mobile number.

Is there any fee for locking or unlocking Aadhaar?

No. The Aadhaar Lock/Unlock service is provided free of cost by UIDAI.

Can I lock and unlock my Aadhaar multiple times?

Yes. Aadhaar number holders can lock and unlock their Aadhaar as many times as required.

Will locking Aadhaar affect my ability to receive government benefits or subsidies?

Aadhaar lock only restricts Aadhaar authentication. If Aadhaar authentication is required for availing a service, the Aadhaar number holder may need to unlock Aadhaar before proceeding

Can I unlock my Aadhaar temporarily for a single authentication?

Aadhaar remains unlocked until the Aadhaar Holder chooses to lock it again. Aadhaar Holder may again lock his/her Aadhaar after completing the required authentication.

How will I know whether my Aadhaar is currently locked or unlocked?

Aadhaar number holders can check the status of their Aadhaar through the Aadhaar Lock/Unlock service available on the myAadhaar portal or Aadhaar app.

Can I lock my Aadhaar if I have not generated a VID?

No. A valid 16-digit VID is required before Aadhaar can be locked.

Is Aadhaar lock different from Biometric Lock?

Yes. Aadhaar Lock restricts all Aadhaar-based authentication using UID, UID Token, and VID. Biometric Lock specifically blocks the use of biometric authentication (fingerprint iris and face authentication) while allowing other authentication modes as applicable.

What is Biometric Locking?

Biometric Locking/Unlocking is a service that allows an Aadhaar holder to lock and temporarily unlock their biometrics. This facility aims to strengthen privacy and confidentiality of Aadhaar number holder's Biometrics Data.

What all Biometric data can be locked?

Fingerprint, iris and Face as a biometric moadlity will be locked and after biometric locking, Aadhaar holder will not be able to perform the Aadhaar authentication using the above mentioned biometric modalities.

What happens when Biometric is locked?

Locked Biometrics confirms that Aadhaar holder will not be able to use Biometrics (fingerprints/iris/Face) for authentication, it is a safety feature to stop any kind of biometric authentication. It also ensures that any entity by any means cannot perform biometric based Aadhaar authentication for that Aadhaar holder.

How to Unlock (locked)Biometrics?

Once Aadhaar number holder enables Biometric Locking system their biometric remains locked till the Aadhaar Holder chose any below mentioned option: Unlock it (which is temporary)or Disable the Locking system The biometric unlock can be done by Aadhaar number holder either by visiting UIDAI website, enrolment centre, Aadhaar Seva Kendra(ASK), through Aadhaar app. Note: Registered Mobile Number is essential to avail this service. In case your mobile number is not registered with Aadhaar visit the nearest Enrolment Centre/Mobile Update End Point.

Who can lock Biometrics?

Aadhaar number holders who have registered mobile number may lock their biometrics.

When to lock Biometrics?

1. When you suspect misuse or see suspicious Aadhaar authentication attempts.
2. When you do not currently need biometric authentication (for example, not using AePS, bank fingerprint, or other biometric-based services).

3. As a preventive safety measure to minimise the risk of biometric-based fraud while you continue using OTP or demographic authentication.

What kind of error is displayed when biometrics are locked during Aadhaar authentication?

When biometrics are locked during Aadhaar authentication, the system typically shows an Authentication failed message with Error Code 330, which means Biometrics locked by Aadhaar holder.

Can biometric locking be done without a registered mobile number?

No, a registered mobile number is mandatory to avail the Biometric Locking/Unlocking service. OTP-based authentication is required to enable or disable this feature. Aadhaar holders without a registered mobile number must first update it through an Aadhaar Enrolment/Update Centre or Aadhaar Seva Kendra.

How long does the temporary biometric unlock remain active?

The temporary unlock of biometrics is valid for a limited duration (generally 15 minutes) or for a single authentication transaction, after which the biometrics are automatically locked again. This ensures continued security of biometric data.

What should an Aadhaar holder do if biometric misuse is suspected?

In case of suspected misuse of biometric data, the Aadhaar holder should immediately lock their biometrics using available channels such as the UIDAI website or Aadhaar application. Additionally, they may review authentication history and report the concern to the Unique Identification Authority of India for further assistance.

Will biometric locking impact Aadhaar-based services like eKYC?

Yes, biometric locking will impact services that rely on biometric authentication such as biometric-based eKYC. However, Aadhaar holders can still use OTP-based eKYC or temporarily unlock their biometrics to complete such services.

Can biometric locking be enabled or disabled multiple times?

Yes, Aadhaar holders can enable or disable the biometric locking facility multiple times as per their requirement. This flexibility allows users to manage their biometric security conveniently through services provided by the Unique Identification Authority of India.

Does biometric locking affect OTP-based authentication?

No, biometric locking does not impact OTP-based authentication. Aadhaar holders can continue to use OTP authentication services even when their biometrics (fingerprint/iris/face) are locked.

Virtual ID (VID)

What is Virtual ID (VID)?

VID is a temporary, revocable 16-digit random number mapped with the Aadhaar number. VID can be used in lieu of Aadhaar number whenever authentication or e-KYC services are performed. Authentication may be performed using VID in a manner similar to using Aadhaar number. It is not possible to derive Aadhaar number from VID.

How does an Aadhaar number holder obtain VID?

VID can be generated only by the Aadhaar number holder. They can also replace (generate a new VID) their VID from time to time. At any given time only one VID will be valid for an Aadhaar number. UIDAI provide various options to Aadhaar

number holders to generate their VID, retrieve their VID in case they forget, and replace their VID with a new number. These options will be made available via UIDAI's website (www.myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in), eAadhaar download, Aadhaar mobile application, etc.
VID can also be generated by sending an SMS to the Aadhaar helpline number 1947. Aadhaar number holder will have to type "GVIDLast 4 digits of Aadhaar Number" and send it to 1947 through the registered Mobile Number.

Can anyone else generate VID for me?

No other entity like AUA/KUA can generate VID on behalf of Aadhaar number holder. The VID can be generated by Aadhaar number holder by himself/herself only. Aadhaar number holder will receive the VID through SMS on registered mobile number.

What if an Aadhaar number holder forgets VID? Can he/she obtain again?

Yes, UIDAI provide multiple ways to generate new and/or retrieve current VID. These options are made available via UIDAI's website (www.myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in), eAadhaar, Aadhaar mobile application, SMS, etc. For retrieval of VID, Aadhaar number holder may send SMS to the Aadhaar helpline number 1947. Aadhaar number holder will have to type "RVID Last 4 digits of Aadhaar Number" and send it to 1947 through the registered Mobile Number.

Can VID be used for OTP or biometrics or demographics authentication?

Yes. VID can be used in lieu of Aadhaar number to perform Aadhaar Authentication.

In case of VID, do I need to provide consent for authentication?

Yes, Aadhaar number holder consent is necessary for VID based authentication. Agency is required to inform the Aadhaar number holder the purpose for authentication and collect explicit consent for performing authentication.

Can an agency store VID?

No. Since VID is temporary and can be changed by the Aadhaar number holder, storing VID has no value. Agencies should not store VID in any database or logs.

Will re-generation of VID lead to the same VID or a different VID?

After the minimum validity period (currently set as 1 calender day or after midnight 12), Aadhaar number holder may requests regeneration of a new VID. In this way, new VID will be generated and the previous VID will be deactivated. In case, if Aadhaar number holder opts for retrieval of VID, the last active VID will be sent to the Aadhaar number holder through SMS. Aadhaar number holder will have to type “RVIDLast 4 digits of Aadhaar Number” and send it to 1947 through the registered Mobile Number.

What is the expiry period of VID?

At this time there is no expiry period defined for VID. VID will be valid till the time a new VID is generated by the Aadhaar number holder.

Authentication History

What is Aadhaar Authentication history?

Aadhaar Authentication History is the record of your Aadhaar number used for authentication, such as biometric, OTP, or demographic verification.

Where can an Aadhaar number holder check his/her Aadhaar Authentication history?

An Aadhaar number holder can check Aadhaar Authentication History at:

1. UIDAI website: https://myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in/

2. Aadhaar mobile app

What is the procedure for checking Aadhaar Authentication history on UIDAI websites?

An Aadhaar number holder can check his/her Aadhaar Authentication history on the UIDAI website at https://myaadhaar.uidai.gov.in/ or through the Aadhaar app by entering his/her Aadhaar number/VID, providing the security code, and following the instructions given on the portal.
Note: Registered mobile number is mandatory to use this service.

What Information Aadhaar number holder can get from Aadhaar Authentication history?

Aadhaar number holder can get the following information in Aadhaar Authentication history against every Authentication done by Aadhaar number holder.

1. Auth Modality.
2. Date & Time of Authentication.
3. UIDAI Response code.
4. AUA Name
5. AUA Transaction ID (With Code)
6. Authentication Response (Success/Failure)
7. UIDAI Error code"

This facility allows me to view maximum 50 authentication records. How can I check more records?

Aadhaar number holder can view details of all authentication records performed by any Authentication User Agency (AUA) or by the holder themselves within the

last 6 months. However, a maximum of 50 records can be viewed at a time. To check additional records, the Aadhaar number holder may select a narrower date range in the calendar, and the corresponding authentication records will then be displayed.

Some of authentication transactions records are showing as failed, what should I do?

For every failed authentication transaction record, specific error code is assigned. Please check the details of error code number against that failed authentication transaction to know the reason of failure.

If I have not performed some of the transactions listed in the records, what should I do?

If the listed authentication transaction is not performed by the Aadhaar number holder, Aadhaar number holder may contact the respective Authentication User Agency (AUA) for further details.

What is UIDAI Response Code in the authentication records?

UIDAI Response Code is a unique code that UIDAI generates for every Aadhaar authentication transaction. It helps the service provider (AUA) and UIDAI to identify that specific transaction and can be used for any follow-up enquiry by the Aadhaar number holder.

What is AUA Transaction ID in the authentication records?

For every authentication transaction performed by an Aadhaar number holder, AUA generates a unique Transaction ID to identify the transaction and sends the same to UIDAI as part of the authentication request. This Transaction ID along with Response Code can be used for any further enquiry from AUA by the Aadhaar number holder.

What is Auth Modality?

UIDAI provides authentication facility with different modes such as demographic, biometric (fingerprint, Iris or face) or One Time Password (OTP). Auth Modality shows the mode of authentication used to perform that specific authentication transaction.

What are Error Codes?

An Error Code provide the details/reason for the failure of authentication transaction. For Error Codes details, Aadhaar number holder may refer to Aadhaar Authentication API document published on UIDAI website.
Below are Error Code List -
“100” – Personal information demographic data did not match.
“200” – Personal address demographic data did not match.
“300” – Biometric data did not match.
“310” – Duplicate fingers used.
“311” – Duplicate Irises used.
“312” – FMR and FIR cannot be used in same transaction.
“313” – Single FIR record contains more than one finger.
“314” – Number of FMR/FIR should not exceed 10.
“315” – Number of IIR should not exceed 2.
“316” – Number of FID should not exceed 1.
“330” – Biometrics locked by Aadhaar holder.
“400” – Invalid OTP value.
“402” – “txn” value did not match with “txn” value used in Request OTP API.
“500” – Invalid encryption of session key.
“501” – Invalid certificate identifier in “ci” attribute of “Skey”.
“502” – Invalid encryption of PID.
“503” – Invalid encryption of Hmac.
“504” – Session key re-initiation required due to expiry or key out of sync.
“505” – Synchronized Key usage not allowed for the AUA.

“510” – Invalid Auth XML format.
“511” – Invalid PID XML format.
“512” – Invalid Aadhaar holder consent in “rc” attribute of “Auth”.
“520” – Invalid “tid” value.
“521” – Invalid “dc” code under Meta tag.
“524” – Invalid “mi” code under Meta tag.
“527” – Invalid “mc” code under Meta tag.
“530” – Invalid authenticator code.
“540” – Invalid Auth XML version.
“541” – Invalid PID XML version.
“542” – AUA not authorized for ASA. This error will be returned if AUA and ASA do not have linking in the portal.
“543” – Sub-AUA not associated with “AUA”. This error will be returned if Sub-AUA specified in “sa” attribute is not added as “Sub-AUA” in portal.
“550” – Invalid “Uses” element attributes.
“551” – Invalid “tid” value.
“553” – Registered devices currently not supported. This feature is being implemented in a phased manner.
“554” – Public devices are not allowed to be used.
“555” – rdsId is invalid and not part of certification registry.
“556” – rdsVer is invalid and not part of certification registry.
“557” – dpId is invalid and not part of certification registry.
“558” – Invalid dih. “559” – Device Certificate has expired.
“560” – DP Master Certificate has expired.
“561” – Request expired (“Pid->ts” value is older than N hours where N is a configured threshold in authentication server).
“562” – Timestamp value is future time (value specified “Pid->ts” is ahead of authentication server time beyond acceptable threshold).
“563” – Duplicate request (this error occurs when exactly same authentication request was re-sent by AUA).

“564” – HMAC Validation failed.
“565” – AUA license has expired.
“566” – Invalid non-decryptable license key.
“567” – Invalid input (this error occurs when unsupported characters were found in Indian language values, “lname” or “lav”).
“568” – Unsupported Language.
“569” – Digital signature verification failed (means that authentication request XML was modified after it was signed).
“570” – Invalid key info in digital signature (this means that certificate used for signing the authentication request is not valid – it is either expired, or does not belong to the AUA or is not created by a well-known Certification Authority).
“571” – PIN requires reset.
“572” – Invalid biometric position.
“573” – Pi usage not allowed as per license.
“574”– Pa usage not allowed as per license.
“575”– Pfa usage not allowed as per license.
“576” - FMR usage not allowed as per license.
“577” – FIR usage not allowed as per license.
“578” – IIR usage not allowed as per license.
“579” – OTP usage not allowed as per license.
“580” – PIN usage not allowed as per license.
“581” – Fuzzy matching usage not allowed as per license.
“582” – Local language usage not allowed as per license.
“586” – FID usage not allowed as per license. This feature is being implemented in a phased manner.
“587” – Name space not allowed.
“588” – Registered device not allowed as per license.
“590” – Public device not allowed as per license.
“710” – Missing “Pi” data as specified in “Uses”.
“720” – Missing “Pa” data as specified in “Uses”.

“721” – Missing “Pfa” data as specified in “Uses”.
“730” – Missing PIN data as specified in “Uses”.
“740” – Missing OTP data as specified in “Uses”.
“800” – Invalid biometric data.
“810” – Missing biometric data as specified in “Uses”.
“811” – Missing biometric data in CIDR for the given Aadhaar number.
“812” – Aadhaar holder has not done “Best Finger Detection”. Application should initiate BFD to help Aadhaar holder identify their best fingers.
“820” – Missing or empty value for “bt” attribute in “Uses” element.
“821” – Invalid value in the “bt” attribute of “Uses” element.
“822” – Invalid value in the “bs” attribute of “Bio” element within “Pid”.
“901” – No authentication data found in the request (this corresponds to a scenario wherein none of the auth data – Demo, Pv, or Bios – is present).
“902” – Invalid “dob” value in the “Pi” element (this corresponds to a scenarios wherein “dob” attribute is not of the format “YYYY” or “YYYYMM-DD”, or the age is not in valid range).
“910” – Invalid “mv” value in the “Pi” element.
“911” – Invalid “mv” value in the “Pfa” element.
“912” – Invalid “ms” value.
“913” – Both “Pa” and “Pfa” are present in the authentication request (Pa and Pfa are mutually exclusive).
“930 to 939” – Technical error that are internal to authentication server.
“940” – Unauthorized ASA channel.
“941” – Unspecified ASA channel.
“950” – OTP store related technical error.
“951” – Biometric lock related technical error.
“980” – Unsupported option.
“995” – Aadhaar suspended by competent authority.
“996” – Aadhaar cancelled (Aadhaar is no in authenticable status).
“997” – Aadhaar suspended (Aadhaar is not in authenticatable status).

“998” – Invalid Aadhaar Number.
“999” – Unknown error.

Can Aadhaar Authentication History be accessed without a registered mobile number?

No

Can I download or print my Aadhaar Authentication History?

Yes, Aadhaar number holders can view and download/print their authentication history from the UIDAI portal for personal reference, subject to the available records within the selected date range.

Is there any limit for downloding my Aadhaar Authentication History? For how many months Aadhaar Authentication History may be downloaded

6 Months

What should I do if I notice frequent unknown authentication attempts?

"If multiple unknown or suspicious authentication attempts are observed, the Aadhaar holder should immediately:

1. Lock your Aadhaar biometrics (or Aadhaar) from the UIDAI website or Aadhaar app so that no one can use your biometrics without your consent
2. Contact the concerned Authentication User Agency (AUA)
3. Report the issue to UIDAI at help@uidai.gov.in or helpline number-1947"

Can I check Aadhaar Authentication History using Virtual ID (VID)?

Yes

How frequently is Aadhaar Authentication History updated?

Aadhaar Authentication History is updated regularly and reflects authentication transactions shortly after they are performed, ensuring near real-time tracking of activities.

Is Aadhaar Authentication History available for organizations or only individuals?

Aadhaar Authentication History is available only to Aadhaar number holders (individuals) for viewing their own authentication transactions.
Organizations can see their own AUA_level transaction logs (for their systems), but they cannot directly view another person's Aadhaar Authentication History

Aadhaar Data vault (ADV) / Hardware Security Module (HSM)

What do you mean by Aadhaar related data?

Aadhaar related data means Aadhaar number along with demographics details i.e. Name, DoB, Gender, Address and Photo, email ID or mobile number.

What are reference keys?

In order to minimize the footprints of the Aadhaar numbers and its connected data within the infrastructure of REs, each Aadhaar number is to be referred by an additional key called Reference Key. These keys will replace Aadhaar numbers in the organizations ecosystem. Mapping of reference key and Aadhaar number is to be maintained in the Aadhaar Data Vault.

What is Hardware Security Module (HSM)?

A Hardware Security Module (HSM) is a tamper-resistant physical device mandated for securely generating, protecting, and managing cryptographic keys used in Aadhaar authentication and e-KYC transactions. All private keys for digital signing of authentication XML and for decrypting e-KYC data must reside only within the HSM, never outside it, to ensure high-grade security and compliance with FIPS 140-2 Level 3.

What is objective of HSM?

The objective of a Hardware Security Module (HSM) is to provide a dedicated, tamper-resistant environment for the secure generation, storage, and management of cryptographic keys.

Can a single HSM be shared between AUA/KUA and their Sub-AUAs/Sub KUAs?

Sub-AUA/Sub-KUA may use their respective AUA's/KUA's HSM, subject to adherence to the following stipulations:

1. The HSM configuration must ensure logical isolation for each RE.
2. Dedicated cryptographic keys for each RE shall be provisioned and maintained within the logical isolation of HSM.
3. Implementation of Identity & Access Management (IAM) to control and monitor all access to cryptographic keys and associated interfaces.
4. Multifactor authentication, Multirole-based Access Control and robust Audit Logging must be enforced to safeguard access and to provide traceability for all cryptographic operations.

Can existing HSMs be used for storing the encryption keys?

REs may use their existing HSM for storing the keys used for encryption of data stored in Aadhaar data vault. However, these keys cannot be shared with any

other RE, except for their authorized Sub-AUAs/KUAs. To facilitate this, the AUAs/KUAs must provide a separate logical partition within the HSM for each of its Sub-AUAs/Sub-KUAs to store the respective encryption keys including IP whitelisting. REs is responsible for ensuring the security of the partitions that store Aadhaar data vault keys.

Is it allowed to store Aadhaar Number and connected data in other systems than vault if the system provides HSM level encryption for storage / usage of Aadhaar Number

All REs are directed to mandatorily store Aadhaar numbers along with any connected Aadhaar data (i.e. eKYC XML containing Aadhaar number and its demographic data) in ADV implemented with HSM. If the RE wants to convert the existing Database into Aadhaar Data Vault (ADV) complying to latest Circular issued by UIDAI time to time, such RE may do so. In that case, the RE must ensure that the Aadhaar numbers are only stored on this ADV and removed from other databases.

What is Aadhaar Data Vault?

Aadhaar Data Vault is a separate secure database/vault/system for Aadhaar data (i.e. Ekyc XML containing Aadhaar number and its demographic data) received by the requesting entities (RE) for specific purposes approved under Aadhaar Act, 2 0 1 6 and associated Regulations thereunder. It is established along with HSM.

What is the objective of Aadhaar Data Vault?

Objective of Aadhaar Data Vault is to minimize footprints of the Aadhaar numbers by encrypting it and its connected data and before securely storing it within the infrastructure of REs.

Who needs to implement Aadhaar Data Vault?

All REs storing full Aadhaar number along with any connected Aadhaar data in accordance with the Aadhaar Act, 2016 and associated regulations and any directions/guidelines issued hereafter are required to implement Aadhaar data vault.

Are there any implementation guidelines for Aadhaar Data Vault?

Yes, UIDAI has issued implementation guidelines for ADV which is published under Authentication documents at uidai.gov.in on below mentioned link: (https://uidai.gov.in/en/authentication-documents)

What data needs to be stored mandatorily in ADV?

Full Aadhaar number along with any connected Aadhaar data (i.e. eKYC XML containing Aadhaar number and its demographic data) received by the requesting entities (RE) from e-KYC response must be stored only within ADV. Aadhaar number or related data provided by Aadhaar Number Holder (ANH) in Authentication application submitted for authentication (mobile/web) is prohibited to be stored by the RE in any form.

For Sub-AUAs/Sub-KUAs, is it mandatory to implement a dedicated ADV at their end or can they utilize their AUA's/KUA's ADV?

Sub-AUAs/Sub-KUAs may implement their own ADV or use their respective AUA's/KUA's ADV as-a-service subject to implementation of Identity & Access Management (IAM) and ensuring logical segregation. In addition, Sub-AUAs/Sub-KUAs are fully responsible for ensuring compliance with respect to the Aadhaar Act, 2016 and associated regulations as amended thereafter.

Can an AUA/KUA access the data in ADV for their Sub-AUAs/Sub-KUAs?

No, AUA/KUA cannot access any data in ADV of their Sub-AUAs/Sub-KUAs.

Is it required to replace all the Aadhaar number with the reference keys which are being used in the existing infrastructure in multiple databases?

RE needs to create an Aadhaar data vault and replace Aadhaar numbers in all existing databases with the respective reference keys even if Aadhaar number is stored encrypted in several databases within the RE.

Can demographic details (received from e-KYC) be stored locally if Aadhaar and UID Token are not stored with it?

Yes, demographic details can also be stored locally if Aadhaar and UID token are not stored/mapped with it by taking reasonable security safeguards to prevent breach of such data, which shall include, at the minimum, appropriate data security measures, including securing such data through encryption, obfuscation or masking.

Can UID Token alone (without demographic details) be stored locally?

Yes, UID token can be stored safely without encryption after its mapping with reference key by taking reasonable security safeguards to prevent breach of such data, which shall include, at the minimum, appropriate data security measures.

If an entity wants to store the Aadhaar pdf (received from eKYC response) locally, is it permissible from UIDAI side?

No, Aadhaar pdf (received from eKYC response) shall only be stored in encrypted manner inside ADV.

Who all can provide Aadhaar Data Vault as-a-service?

All existing global AUAs/KUAs (implemented a fully compliant ADV), CSPs providing ADV as a service hosted on GCC empaneled cloud or a technical service provider providing on- premises services of ADV can provide ADV as-a-service.

Which encryption algorithm is required for encryption of Aadhaar numbers and related data in the Aadhaar Data Vault?

The encryption algorithm and key strength required for securing Aadhaar numbers and related data in the Aadhaar Data Vault must comply with the latest UIDAI specification, API 2.5 for Authentication and eKYC. These specifications are subject to change, and regulated entities must refer to the latest UIDAI documentation for updated requirements.

Is it possible to use existing unique values, such as Bank account numbers or PAN numbers, for an entity to be used as reference keys?

The organization may use any reference keys as long as it can be uniquely mapped to the respective Aadhaar numbers and meets the requirement of the UIDAI Circulars regarding ADV implementation, such as Aadhaar numbers should not be predictable if corresponding reference keys or set of keys are available. Organization should consider other implications of using Bank account / PAN card as reference keys which may be local to the environment.

Can multiple reference keys be generated and used with a single Aadhaar?

Multiple reference keys may be generated for a single Aadhaar if there is such business case which requires to refer one Aadhaar by different reference keys in the internal ecosystem of the RE. In such cases, the R E shall ensure compliance to the other requirements specified in the UIDAI Circulars/Guidelines on the ADV, as issued by UIDAI time-to-time.

What is the nomenclature / convention to be followed for Unique Reference Number Generation for Aadhaar?

This is left to organization to choose nomenclature/convention as long as it ensures that the recovery of the original Aadhaar number must not be

computationally feasible knowing only the reference key or numbers of reference keys. Hash of Aadhaar No. should not be used as reference key.

As Aadhaar number is used for carrying out DBT transactions, etc., will the Aadhaar number be continued to be used while processing the transactions?

Aadhaar number may be used wherever necessary to process the transactions, however when the transaction related data or Aadhaar related data is stored, Aadhaar numbers should not be stored in any other storage than Aadhaar Data Vault.